

mounted by nationalists in Algeria, which would lead to Algerian independence in 1962.

In Cuba, Fidel Castro's guerrillas overthrew President Fulgencio Batista in 1959, an achievement quickly followed by the resumption of guerrilla warfare in South Vietnam, this time against the regime of Ngo Dinh Diem. By 1965, Castro's erstwhile companion Ernesto "Che" Guevara had launched a call for further guerrilla uprisings as part of a worldwide campaign against American imperialism. The Viet Minh and their successors, the Viet Cong, had helped a military strategy turn into a hazy project for revolution across the world.

3,00,000 The approximate number of Viet Minh guerrillas in 1952.

90,000 The number of French troops operating in Vietnam that year.



Revolution in Cuba

Fidel Castro (left) led a successful guerrilla campaign to take power in Cuba in 1959. His adoption of the communist side in the Cold War convinced the United States of the urgent need to combat revolutionary guerrilla insurgencies.